



incredible win in 1983.

Today, the IPL has shown the world what a well-organised tournament can do. The fruits of that success have spurred Indian franchise owners to venture into other countries and lift those countries' cricketing ecosystems to a higher level than might otherwise have been possible.

This is being written just a few days before India starts its campaign to try and qualify for the ICC World Test Championship Final. The two-match series in Sri Lanka won't be easy, as Sri Lanka at home are a formidable team. Winning both these Tests would be a good start to the new Test season, as well as give the team the impetus it needs to qualify for the WTC Final. To be able to do so requires loads of effort and also some luck but, above all, the belief that Indian cricket should be the priority and not any individual, however big a name he

August gathering: The Mariners Cricket Club (MCC) Singapore hosted The '83 Legends Tour of Singapore, bringing the heroes of India's historic 1983 World Cup triumph together in the island nation for the first time. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

may be.

This column can't end without congratulating our athletes for their terrific performances in the Commonwealth Games. They did the country proud with the medals they brought home. Some missed the gold by a whisker, some missed the bronze by a hair's breadth. Yet they had the country riveted, and the many youngsters watching them will be inspired to go on and do the same in the near future.

Well done, you all. More power for more medals in the future too.

We were simply overwhelmed by the reception and the affection shown at the ground as well as at the gala dinner the previous evening. To have this kind of affection more than 43 years after the team made history is a blessing, pure and simple.